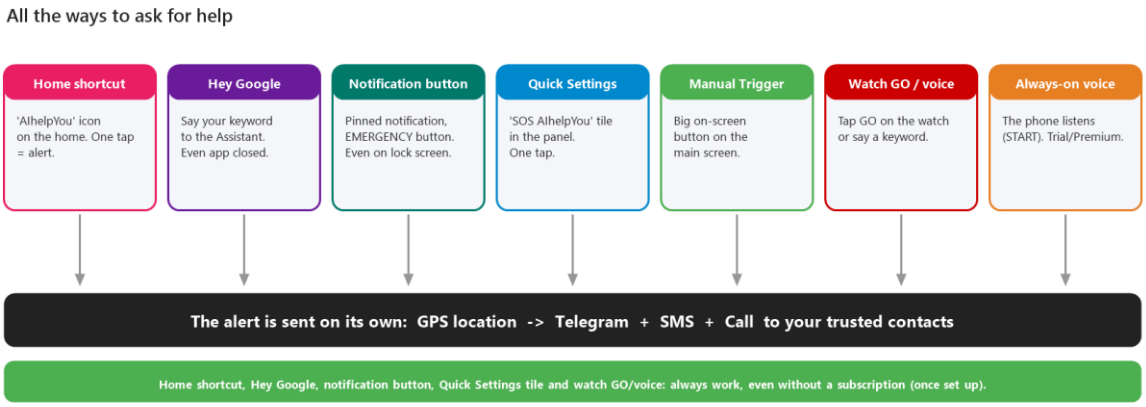
# AlhelpYou

## User Manual

Rapid personal alert system: Android phone + Wear OS watch - 12 languages

Quick Guide + Detailed Manual




*All the ways to ask for help (see Quick Guide).*

# QUICK GUIDE - ask for help in 1 second

This page is all you need in a critical moment. For it to work, the initial setup (contacts + permissions) must already have been completed at least once.

## The immediate ways to send an alert

**1.** HOME SHORTCUT - tap the 'AIhelpYou' icon on the phone's home screen. A single tap sends the alert. Works even with the app closed.

**2.** HEY GOOGLE - say 'Hey Google' followed by your keyword (your first custom keyword). Works even on a locked screen / app closed.

**3.** NOTIFICATION BUTTON - once setup is complete a pinned notification 'AIhelpYou - SOS always available' shows an EMERGENCY button: tap it to send right away, even on a locked screen and with the app closed, without unlocking.

**4.** QUICK SETTINGS TILE - add the 'SOS AIhelpYou' tile to the quick toggles panel: one tap = alert, on many devices even from the lock screen.

**5.** WATCH - press the big red GO button on the watch app, or say a keyword.

**6.** IN THE APP - the big 'Touch for Manual Trigger' button sends the alert immediately.

***[!] IMPORTANT:*** *the home shortcut, 'Hey Google', the notification button, the Quick Settings tile and the watch GO/voice always work, even without a subscription (you only need to have completed the initial setup).*

## What happens when you send an alert

The app gets your GPS location and automatically sends, in parallel, to your trusted contacts: a Telegram message with live location, an SMS with address and Google Maps link, and (if enabled) it starts a call. If you set a name (nickname), the message starts with 'Name needs help' in your chosen language.

# 1. System overview

AIhelpYou is a personal alert system made of two apps that work together:

**Phone app (AIhelpYou):** the core. It listens for your keywords, gets your location and sends the alerts (Telegram, SMS, call) to your trusted contacts.

**Watch app (Wear OS companion):** an emergency remote control: with the GO button or your voice it sends the help command to the phone, which then composes and delivers the messages.

The phone is ALWAYS the only device that sends the messages: the watch only triggers the alert from a distance, even when the phone is in another room or in your pocket.

***[globe] Languages:*** *AIhelpYou supports 12 languages. You pick yours on the first screen and can change it anytime (see chapter 6). The on-screen app text is in English; only the emergency MESSAGE sent to your contacts is written in your chosen language.*

***[i] Privacy:*** *all your data (contacts, keywords, location) stays on your device. No remote tracking: location and contacts leave the phone only during an alert, towards the recipients you chose.*

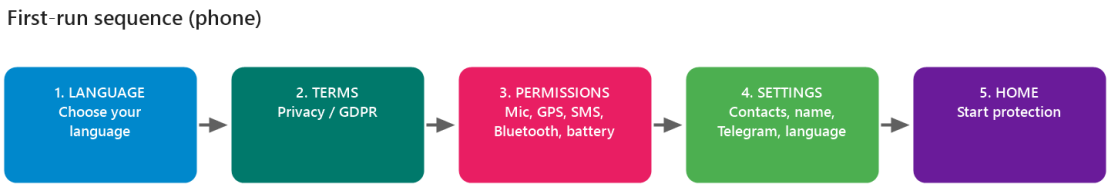
# 2. Installation

## 2.1 Phone app

1. Install AIhelpYou from the Google Play Store (or the provided APK) on an Android phone.
2. Open the app: the first-run flow described in chapter 3 starts.

## 2.2 Watch app: installs BY ITSELF

You do not need to search anything in the watch store. The companion app is installed AUTOMATICALLY on your Wear OS watch when AIhelpYou is installed on the phone and the watch is paired with it (Galaxy Wearable / Wear OS app). It appears among the watch apps within a few minutes.




*First-run sequence of the phone app (language is the first step).*

# 3. First launch and setup

## 3.1 Language, terms and privacy

On first launch you pick your language (see chapter 6), then read and accept the Terms & Conditions / privacy policy, which explains that the app uses microphone, location and SMS/Telegram only to alert your contacts.

## 3.2 Permissions and battery

The app asks for the permissions it needs. Grant them all so the alert can be delivered:

**Microphone:** to recognise the keywords.

**Location (background too, 'Allow all the time'):** to attach the GPS coordinates.

**SMS and Phone:** to send the SMS and start the calls to your contacts.

**Bluetooth (Android 12+):** to talk to the watch even without WiFi (BT channel).

**Notifications:** for the service and alert notifications.

**Battery optimization:** must be DISABLED for the app, otherwise the system can suspend background listening.

***[!] Important:*** *on Xiaomi/Redmi/Poco, Samsung, Oppo, Motorola, Huawei, Vivo, Asus, disabling battery saving requires specific steps: the app guides you with screens tailored to your model. Follow them, otherwise screen-off listening may stop.*

## 3.3 Settings

The Settings screen is where you configure the whole system. The main fields, from the top:

**Language:** your language among the 12 supported (see chapter 6).

**Your name:** the name your contacts know you by (e.g. 'Alice'). If filled in, the messages start with 'Alice needs help'. Empty = message without a name.

**Alert actions:** tick the actions: 'Send Telegram messages', 'Send SMS', 'Make emergency calls'. At least one must be on.

**Telegram Chat IDs:** your Telegram recipients (see chapter 4).

**Phone numbers:** up to two numbers (international format, e.g. +1555...).

**Custom keywords:** up to three personal keywords (the first one is also used by 'Hey Google'). Built-in keywords for your language are already included.

**Live location duration (minutes):** how long your position stays shared in real time on Telegram after an alert. Settable from 1 to 1440 minutes; left empty = 30 minutes by default. Longer durations use more battery (GPS stays on until the live ends).

Tap 'Save'. You need at least one Telegram Chat ID OR one phone number.

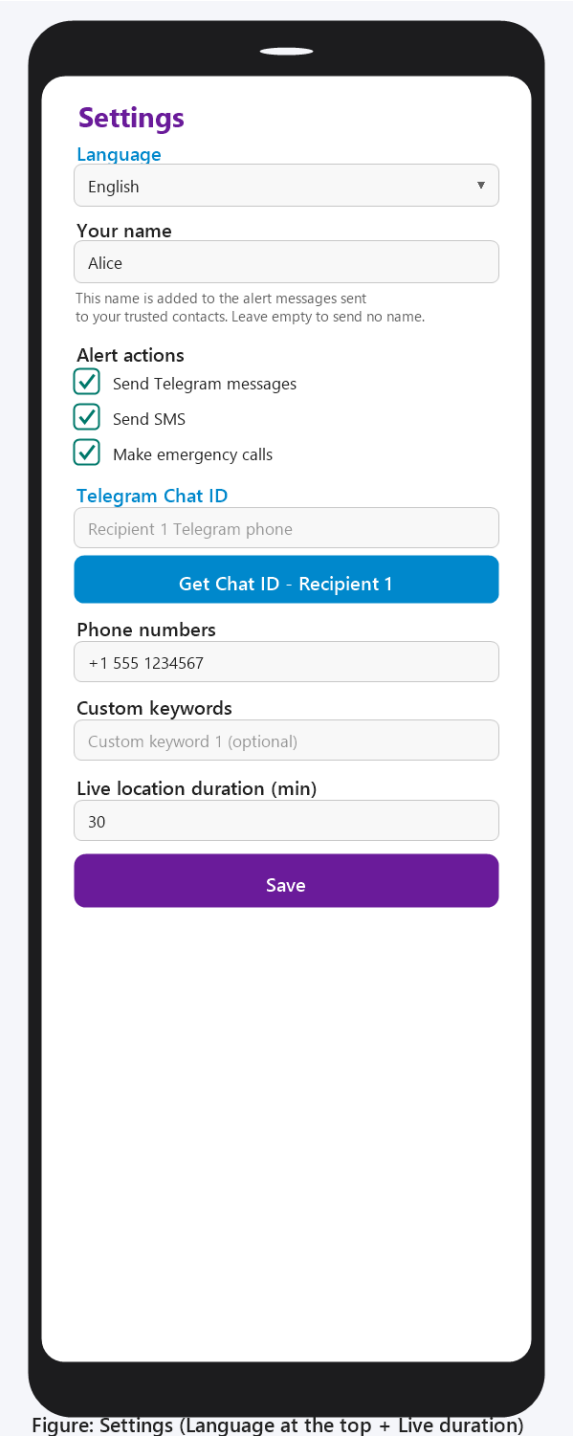



Figure: Settings (Language at the top + Live duration)

*Settings screen (Language at the top, Live duration near the bottom).*

## 4. How to get a Telegram Chat ID

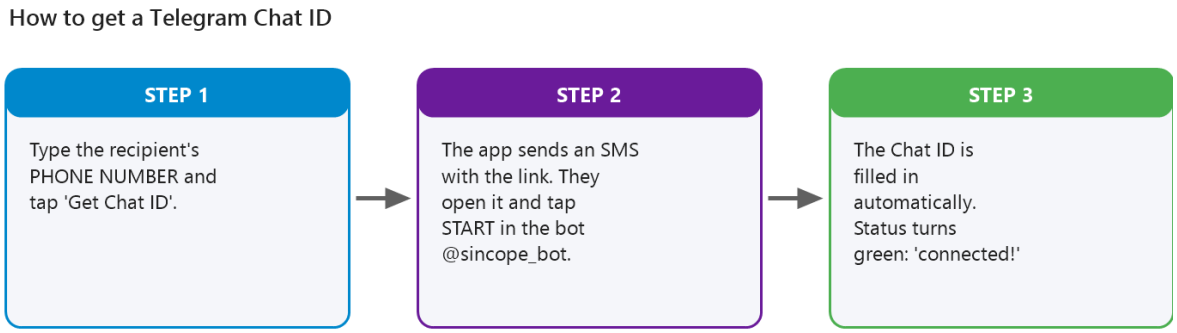
To send Telegram messages the app uses the official bot @sincope_bot. Each recipient has a 'Chat ID', a number that identifies their chat with the bot. You don't need to find it manually: just the recipient's phone number and the app retrieves it on its own.

### Step-by-step

1. In Settings, under Telegram Chat IDs, type the recipient's PHONE NUMBER in the 'Recipient 1 Telegram phone' field.
2. Tap 'Get Chat ID - Recipient 1': the app AUTOMATICALLY sends an SMS to that number with the pairing link (the status shows 'SMS sent to...'). Standard carrier SMS charges may apply.

**3.** The recipient opens the SMS and taps the link: Telegram opens on the bot @sincope_bot. Tap START.

**4.** The Chat ID is filled in AUTOMATICALLY in the app: the status turns green ('Recipient connected!'). From then on they will receive the alerts. You can configure up to two recipients.




*From phone number to Chat ID: the app sends the link by SMS and acquires the Chat ID on its own.*

### If the SMS can't be sent

If you haven't granted the SMS permission (or sending fails), the app keeps the 'Copy link' button ready: copy it and send it to the recipient any way you like (WhatsApp, email...). As soon as they open it and tap START in the bot, their Chat ID still arrives in the app.

## 5. Offline voice recognition

AIhelpYou uses the offline Vosk voice engine: it works without a network and privately (audio stays on the device, nothing is recorded or transmitted).

**On the phone:** the model for your language is loaded on demand (see chapter 6). For Italian, English and Spanish it is already bundled in the app; for other languages it is downloaded once, then works fully offline.

**On the watch:** the watch also has its offline model, on your wrist.

***[i] Timing (watch):*** *on first open (or after the system closed the app) the watch offline engine takes a few seconds to 'warm up' (model loading). It is normal and depends on the watch CPU. The GO button always works INSTANTLY; only hands-free voice has this short warm-up.*

When there is no WiFi, the watch still uses Internet through the phone over Bluetooth: the system online recognition can cover the first moments, then the offline model takes over (faster and local).

## 6. Languages and how to change them

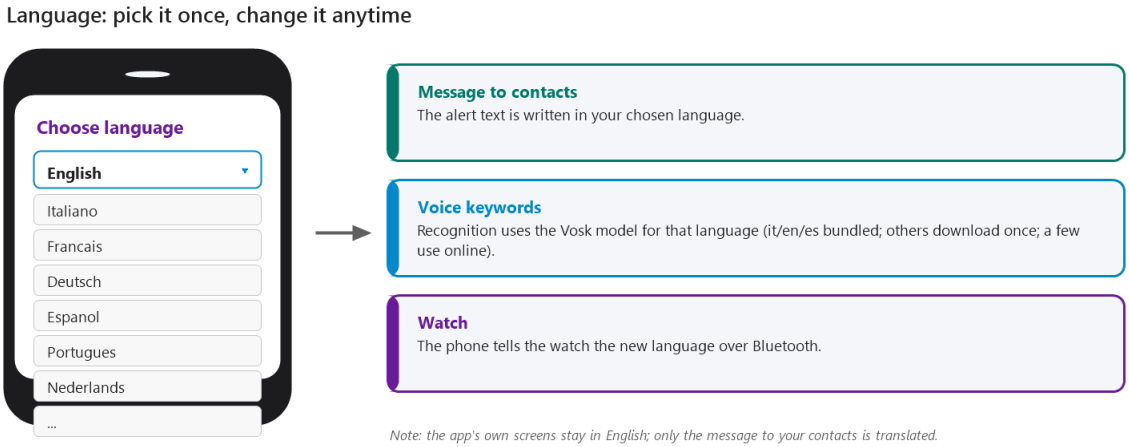
AIhelpYou speaks 12 languages. Choosing or changing the language is simple and affects three things.

### 6.1 Where you choose it

**At first launch:** the very first screen (Welcome) asks you to choose your language from a drop-down list. This is saved and used from then on.

**Anytime later:** open Settings: the 'Language' selector at the top lets you switch language whenever you want. After changing it, tap 'Save'.

## 6.2 What changes when you switch language




*Choose the language once; change it anytime. It affects the contact message, the voice model and the watch.*

**Message to contacts:** the alert text (e.g. 'Alice needs help', address labels, map link) is written in your chosen language.

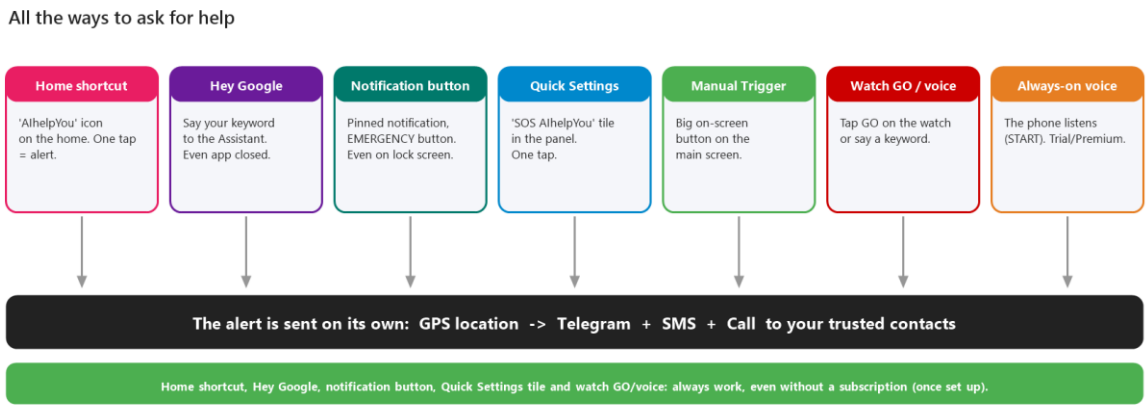
**Voice keywords:** recognition uses the Vosk model for that language. Italian, English and Spanish are bundled (offline ready, no download). Other languages are downloaded once on demand and then work offline. A few languages have no offline model and rely on the system online recognition.

**Watch:** the phone tells the watch the new language over Bluetooth, so the wrist recognition matches.

***[i] Note:*** *the app's own screens (buttons, settings, notifications) stay in English; only the message sent to your contacts is translated. This keeps the interface consistent while every recipient gets the alert in your language.*

***[down] Tip:*** *if your language is not bundled, open Settings, select it, and use the 'download now' button to fetch the offline model in advance - so recognition is instant and works without internet later.*

# 7. How to ask for help (detail)




*Overview of the alert methods and the result.*

## 7.1 On the phone

### Home shortcut ('AIhelpYou') - always works

During setup the app offers to add an 'AIhelpYou' shortcut to the home screen. A single tap sends the alert right away, even with the app closed and even WITHOUT a subscription: you only need to have completed setup. It is the fastest, most reliable way.

### Hey Google - always works

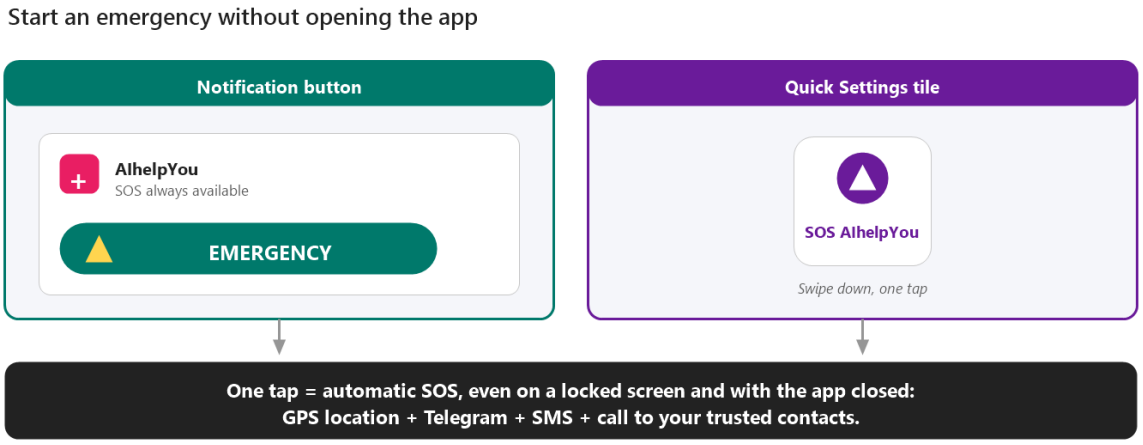
With Google Assistant enabled, saying 'Hey Google, <your keyword>' sends the alert even with the app closed. Requires at least one custom keyword. Works without a subscription.

### 'EMERGENCY' button in the notification - without opening the app

Once setup is complete (even without pressing START) AIhelpYou keeps a pinned notification 'AIhelpYou - SOS always available' with an EMERGENCY button. Tap it to send the alert immediately, even on a locked screen and with the app closed, without unlocking the phone. The notification stays while the app is configured and disappears only if you remove all contacts.

### 'SOS AIhelpYou' tile in Quick Settings - without opening the app

You can add a 'SOS AIhelpYou' tile to the Quick Settings panel (the quick toggles: WiFi, Bluetooth...). After the first Save, on Android 13+ the app offers to add it with one tap; otherwise open the panel fully, tap the pencil/Edit and drag the tile up. From then on: swipe down -> one tap = immediate alert, on many devices even from the lock screen.




*The two new quick ways: notification button and Quick Settings tile.*

### 'Touch for Manual Trigger' button

On the main screen, the big button sends the alert right away.

### START - continuous voice protection

The START button turns on CONTINUOUS background voice listening: the phone keeps listening and fires the alert as soon as you say a keyword, without touching anything. This 'always listening' mode is tied to the 3-day free trial and then to Premium (chapter 8). Pressing it again stops protection.

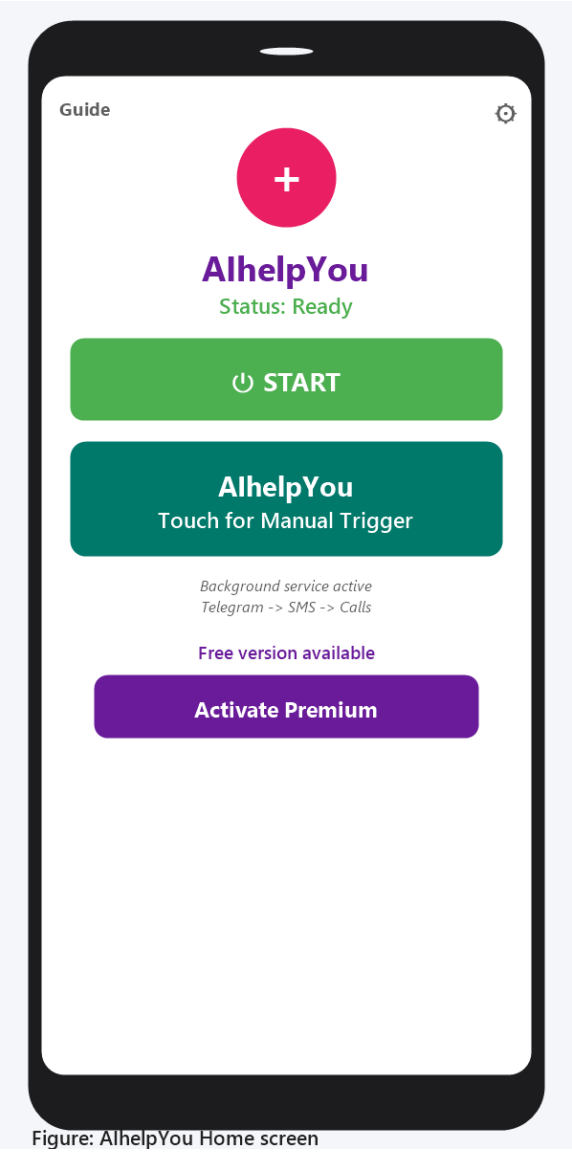



Figure: AlhelpYou Home screen

*Main screen: START, 'Touch for Manual Trigger', Activate Premium.*

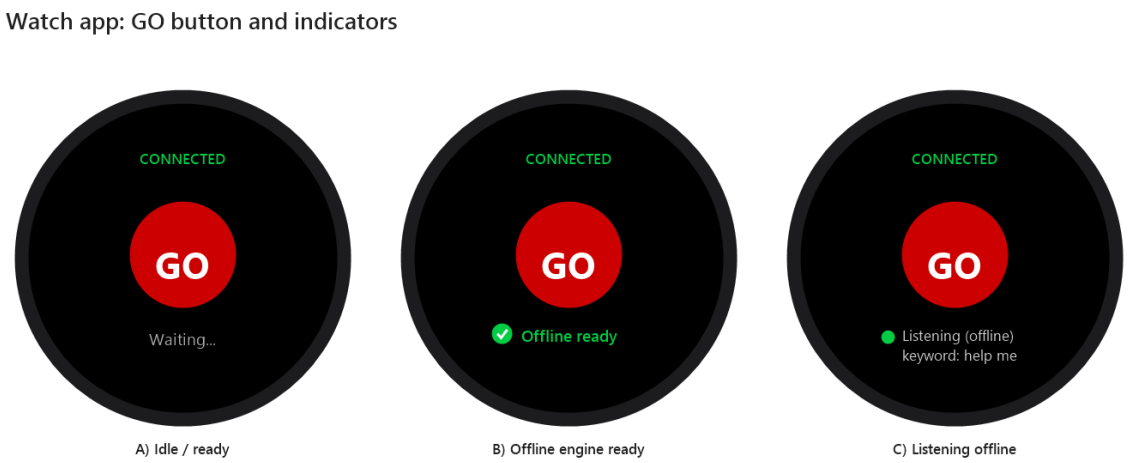
## 7.2 On the watch

### GO button

The watch face has a big red GO button: press it to send the command to the phone right away. At the top you see the connection status ('CONNECTED' when the phone is reachable).

### Voice on the watch

If listening is active, you can say a keyword to the watch: 'Listening (offline)' appears with the active keyword. The watch sends the command to the phone over several channels in parallel (maximum reliability) and the phone delivers the alerts. Below GO you see the indicators: 'Waiting', the green check 'Offline ready', the green dot 'Listening (offline)'.




*Watch app: GO button and status indicators.*

### 7.3 What the message contains

In all cases, after sending, the phone gets the GPS location and sends to your trusted contacts: Telegram with live location + SMS with address and Google Maps link + (if enabled) a call. With your name set, the message starts with 'Name needs help' in your language.

## 8. START/STOP, watch recognition and Premium

**START / STOP:** START begins continuous voice protection; pressing again stops it. The status at the top ('Status: Ready' / 'Listening') reflects it. When protection is active, the 'Touch for Manual Trigger' button stays available.

**3-day free trial:** the first activation starts a free 3-day trial of continuous protection.

**Premium:** after the trial, to keep using the 'always-on' continuous listening you need the subscription ('Activate Premium').

***[*] Always free:*** *even without a subscription - once setup is complete - the home shortcut, 'Hey Google', the notification button, the Quick Settings tile and the watch GO/voice always stay available. Only the automatic CONTINUOUS listening on the phone (START) requires trial/Premium.*

## 9. Tips, battery and troubleshooting

- Keep the app excluded from battery saving (chapter 3.2): it is the main cause of missed screen-off listening.
- Grant the Bluetooth permissions: they are needed for the secure channel with the watch even without WiFi.
- Watch: on first open the offline recognition 'warms up' in a few seconds (model loading on the watch CPU). GO is always instant anyway.
- Away from home without WiFi: the watch uses the phone's Internet over Bluetooth; recognition may be slower until the offline model takes over.
- If the watch shows 'Not connected' or asks to install the app on the phone: bring the phone closer, check Bluetooth and that AIhelpYou is installed and active.
- Test your recipients: send a manual alert and check that you receive SMS and/or Telegram. With your name set the message starts with your name.
- Phone numbers in international format (+...).

### After a phone restart or an app update

When you restart your phone, or when AIhelpYou is updated, voice listening stays suspended until you open the app once. Protection restarts on its own, but Android does not grant the microphone to an app that restarts automatically without you having opened it.

You notice it right away, because the AIhelpYou notification tells you: 'Voice listening suspended - tap here and keep the app open until it shows Listening. The SOS button and the smartwatch still work.'

1. Tap that notification: AIhelpYou opens.
2. Keep it open for a few seconds and watch the notification in the status bar.
3. When it goes back to 'Listening...' voice listening is active again and you can close the app. From then on it keeps working with the screen off and the app closed.

*[*] You are still protected meanwhile: the EMERGENCY button in the notification, the home shortcut, 'Hey Google', the Quick Settings tile and the watch GO button all work normally. Only automatic voice recognition is suspended.*

*[!] Why we cannot avoid it: this is a privacy protection built into Android, not a flaw in AIhelpYou. The system prevents any app from silently turning on the microphone when it restarts by itself after a reboot. No app can bypass it, and we do not want to. That is why we chose to have the app tell you clearly instead of pretending to listen.*

### The 'SOS always available' notification

AIhelpYou keeps a permanent, silent notification in the status bar with the EMERGENCY button: that is what lets you raise an alert with a single tap even when the app is closed and the phone is locked. If you swipe it away by mistake, it comes back on its own within a few seconds.

If you prefer not to see it, you can switch it off from Android without affecting anything else:

1. Open the Android Settings > Apps > AIhelpYou > Notifications.
2. Turn off the category 'SOS always available'.

Turning that category back on restores the button within a few seconds. The separate category 'AIhelpApp Service' is the one that shows the app is running: leave it on.

*[!] What you give up: without this notification the EMERGENCY quick button disappears from the status bar and the lock screen. Every other way to ask for help keeps working: the in-app button, the voice command, 'Hey Google', the SOS Quick Settings tile and the smartwatch.*

## 10. AIhelpButton - the wireless help button

AIhelpButton is a small Bluetooth button you keep with you: in a pocket, on a keyring, around your neck. Hold it down and AIhelpYou raises the alert exactly as if you had pressed the button inside the app: same message, same position, same recipients. It works with the phone in your bag, screen off and the app closed.

### What you need

- The AIhelpButton device, with a working battery.
- Bluetooth switched on on the phone.
- AIhelpYou installed and configured with at least one recipient.

### How to pair it (first time)

Pairing is done once. You do not have to use the Android Bluetooth menu: everything happens inside AIhelpYou.

1. Open AIhelpYou and tap the gear icon at the top right to open Settings.
2. Scroll down to the 'Connected Devices' section.
3. Tick the box 'AIhelpButton'.
4. Right below it appears, in pink: 'Press your AIhelpButton now to pair it'. That message means the app is waiting for you.
5. Press the button on your AIhelpButton device and hold it for about a second. This is how the app recognises YOUR button and not somebody else's.
6. The pink message disappears and the indicator turns green: 'Button state: connected (idle)'. Pairing is done.
7. Tap 'SAVE CONFIGURATION' at the bottom to store the setting.

***[OK] How to be sure it worked:*** *in the 'AIhelpButton settings' panel you now see the button name and its battery level. Those two lines are read from the device itself: if they are filled in, the connection is real.*

***[i] If more than one button is nearby:*** *the app pairs with the one you actually press, so press only the device you want to use.*

## The status indicator

Under 'AIhelpButton' there is a coloured dot that always tells the truth about the device:

- Green 'connected (idle)': everything is fine, the button is ready.
- Red 'PRESSED': you are pressing it right now (useful to check that it responds).
- Orange 'not connected': the button is out of range, switched off, or the battery is flat. In this state the button CANNOT raise an alert.
- Grey 'not paired': no button has been paired yet.

The same information appears in the AIhelpYou notification: 'AIhelpButton: ready' or 'AIhelpButton unreachable'. When you walk away and come back, the phone reconnects on its own: you do not have to do anything.

## Pairing: two ways, and you should try the first one

When no button is paired yet, the AIhelpButton panel offers two buttons. They are not the same thing, so it is worth knowing which is which.

### Pair the button - the normal way

Tap it, then rest your button on the phone and hold it down until the status changes to 'Connecting...'. Use this for the AIhelpButton and for any model the app already recognises. It is immediate and needs no connection: try it first.

### New or unrecognised button - the long way

Tap it, then follow the instructions on the screen: the app works out by itself how your button speaks. It asks you to press and hold three times, then once more to confirm. Use it for a button from another manufacturer, or if the normal pairing above does not succeed.

***[!] Start by tapping the button on the SCREEN:*** *resting your button near the phone does nothing on its own. If you never tap one of the two buttons, nothing happens at all - and it is easy to conclude that the button is broken when it is not.*

A button from another manufacturer is usable only if it signals BOTH the press and the release: without the release there is no way to measure how long you held it, and the pocket protection could not exist. The app checks this by itself and refuses to pair a button it cannot measure, rather than pairing one that would fail silently later.

***[!] Bluetooth must be on:*** *the button talks over Bluetooth. If it is off, the app now tells you and offers to open the phone settings. Without Bluetooth the button can neither be paired nor call for help.*

## How to use it

Hold the button down for the time shown by the sensitivity you chose (4 seconds by default), then release. A short accidental touch does NOT raise an alert - this is on purpose, so the button can stay in your pocket.

## Sensitivity

In the 'AIhelpButton settings' panel you can choose how long the press must last:

- High - hold for 2 seconds: quicker, but easier to trigger by accident.
- Medium - hold for 3 seconds.
- Low - hold for 4 seconds (recommended): the safest against accidental presses in a pocket or a bag.

Hold it a little longer than the time shown: the press travels over Bluetooth, and the app measures it with a tolerance of about half a second. Counting calmly is enough - there is no penalty for holding it too long.

## Battery of the button

The panel shows the level and WHEN it was measured (for example '97% - measured 3 hours ago'), because the level can only be read at certain moments. Tap 'Refresh battery now' to read it again: during those few seconds the button is briefly offline, then it reconnects by itself.

***[!] Low battery:*** *when the battery gets low AIhelpYou warns you with a notification. Replace it promptly: a flat button cannot ask for help, and the app will show 'unreachable'.*

## Testing it without waiting for a real emergency

Use 'Test button' in the panel: it sends a REAL alert to your contacts, exactly like a genuine press. Warn your recipients before using it.

## Replacing or removing the button

If you buy a new AIhelpButton, or you want the app to forget the current one, tap 'Unpair / change button' and confirm. The app forgets the device and shows again 'Press your AIhelpButton now to pair it': at that point press the new button and it is paired, exactly like the first time.

To switch the feature off completely, simply untick 'AIhelpButton' in 'Connected Devices' and save.

## If the button does not work

- Check the indicator first: if it says 'not connected', the problem is the link, not the press. Bring the phone closer and check Bluetooth.
- Make sure 'AIhelpButton' is still ticked in 'Connected Devices' and that you saved.
- Hold it longer: with the recommended setting the press must last a full 4 seconds.
- Check the battery of the button in the panel.
- If it still fails, tap 'Unpair / change button' and pair it again from scratch.

***[!] The button is an addition, never the only way:*** *the EMERGENCY button in the notification, the quick button in the app, the voice command and the smartwatch keep working independently of AIhelpButton.*

# The emergency number button

In Settings you can store your country's single emergency number - 112 across the European Union, 999 in the United Kingdom, 911 in the United States and Canada - choosing it from a list or typing it yourself. A red button then appears on the main screen.

> ***[!] This button does not place the call:*** *it opens the dialler with the number already typed in, and you press the green key. No app on Android is allowed to dial an emergency number on its own - this is a rule of the operating system, not a limitation of AIhelpYou.*

## Why you should not put 112 among your contacts

The two phone numbers in Settings are for your personal contacts. If you enter an emergency number there, the automatic call would fail silently and the text message would go nowhere. The app warns you if you try.

## Choosing the number

Pick the country from the list and the number appears by itself, but the field stays editable: you can always correct it by hand. Use 'Other' to type any number. If you travel often, remember that the right number is the one of the country you are IN, not the one you live in: 112 works throughout the European Union and in many other countries.

If you prefer not to see the button, simply untick 'Show the Emergency number button' in Settings.

# Safety reminder

AIhelpYou is an alerting tool towards personal contacts and does not replace the official emergency numbers. In case of serious danger always contact, when possible, your country's emergency services. Periodically check that contacts, keywords and permissions are configured correctly with a test.